The Laboratory Mock Inspection Checklist

Rehearse a Joint Commission laboratory survey, phase by phase, and find your gaps before a surveyor does. Built by a former Joint Commission laboratory surveyor with more than 200 facility inspections.

Scope and footprint

- ❑ List every place testing occurs, including bedside and point-of-care sites in the ED and on the units.
- ❑ Confirm every testing site is under your CLIA certificate and known to the laboratory.
- ❑ Assign an independent reviewer who does not run the area being reviewed.

Proficiency testing and licensure

- ❑ Pull every PT score below 100 percent for the last two years.
- ❑ Confirm each has an attestation, a documented review, and a corrective action (including passing scores with an incorrect result).
- ❑ Confirm the laboratory director file (license, board certification, qualification) is current.
- ❑ Confirm referral-laboratory and pathology contracts and their evaluations are current.

Quality control, maintenance, and records

- ❑ Pull QC, maintenance, and temperature records for three or four sample months.
- ❑ Confirm documented monthly review, and that the review would actually have caught what is in the record.
- ❑ Confirm correlation and linearity studies are on the six-month interval, within the twenty-day window.
- ❑ Check the verification done for any new test or instrument, and the validation of the information system.
- ❑ Pull safety records: fire drills, waste manifests, the emergency operations plan, and chemical exposure monitoring.

Tracers: follow real patients

- ❑ Pick a transfusion and a critical value from the record; reconstruct each from the patient chart, not the laboratory system.
- ❑ On a critical value, confirm documentation that the ordering provider, not only nursing, was notified.
- ❑ On a transfusion, confirm the vital-sign monitoring matches your blood administration policy, line by line.

Personnel

- ❑ Pull the file of every employee named in your tracers.
- ❑ Confirm competency, the job-description match, and primary-source-verified credentials.
- ❑ Confirm annual training such as HIPAA and bloodborne pathogens.

Observed procedures

- ❑ Watch a transfusion, a phlebotomy and arterial draw, a positive blood culture workup, and a point-of-care glucose.

- ❑ Review each policy first, then note any point where the observed practice departs from it.

Close it out

- ❑ Write each finding with the standard or CFR reference.
- ❑ Rank each finding by risk: how likely it is to reach a patient and how widespread it is, the way the SAFER matrix does.
- ❑ Assign corrective actions with named owners and due dates, and re-check open items before the real survey.

VeritaAssure® keeps your lab survey-ready, from the proficiency testing and correlation records a surveyor pulls first to the competency and policy documentation the tracers reach. veritaslabservices.com